

AP



ZUBIN
MEHTA

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73, Music Composer

Baron of the Baton

Because he is one of the world's greatest conductors and also one of the first Indians to make America their artistic home. **Because** he is a citizen of the world, never allowing politics to get in the way of his music, spearheading the Israeli Philharmonic Orchestra even when India did not have formal relations with the nation, and conducting *Turandot* in China.

Did you know?

His house in California, where he lives with wife Nancy, belonged to actor Steve McQueen.

BANDEEP SINGH

The Top Title

Because he is among the most influential publishers in the world, with Knopf viewed as a bastion of high-brow literature and the *New York Review of Books*, 2008, selecting eight Knopf titles in a list of 10.

Because the recent shake-up at parent company Random House has left one half of New York's uber power couple (his wife is the writer Gita Mehta) with an expanded empire that includes Doubleday.

SONNY
MEHTA

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66, Publisher

Did you know?

He loves solitude. Hates the Nicorette gum he is forced to chew after quitting smoking.

The Provocateur

Because even after pronouncing the death of a novel, he has written two and is working on one on Africa. **Because** writing on him gets as much attention as writing by him, as Paul Theroux and Patrick French have shown, and even when he attacks literary greats like Dickens and Austen, no one winces.

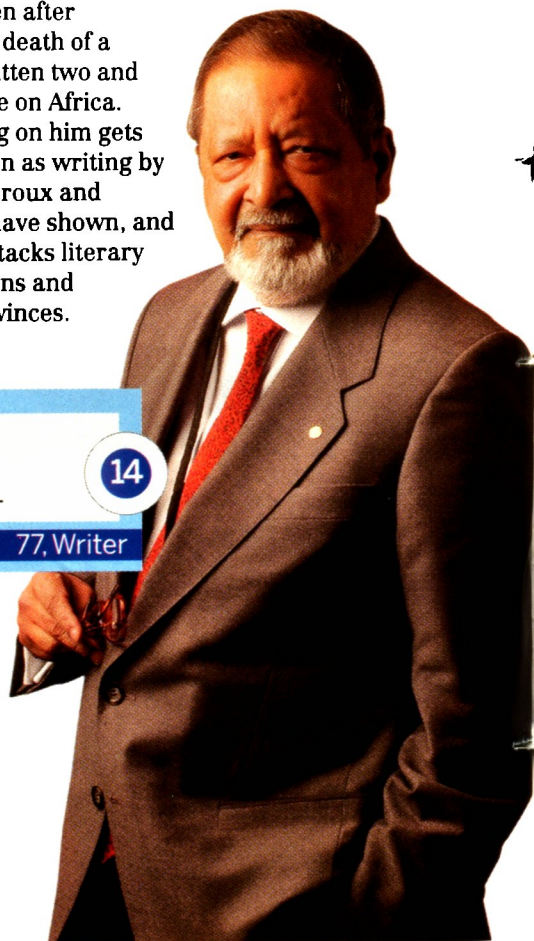
V.S.
NAIPAUL

14

77, Writer

Did you know?

Loves the *dal* at Bombay Brasserie, the upscale Indian restaurant in London.



BANDEEP SINGH